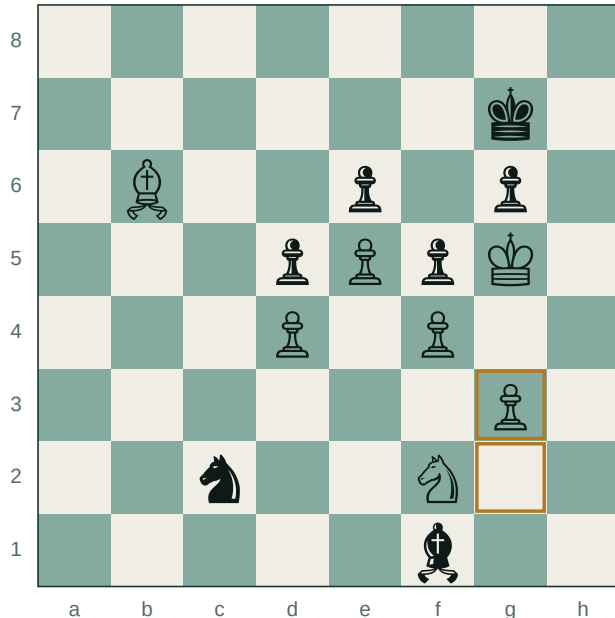


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 55

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 55.g3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55...Ne1 56. g4 Nf3#

55...Ne1 The knight moves from c2 to e1. Recorded reply: **56.g4**.

56...Nf3# Mate: knight on f3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on f3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b6 and knight on f2. Check for tactical protection.